Listing 9.17 Using a `prefix` query

```
GET movies/_search
{
  "query": {
    "prefix": {
      "actors.original": {
        "value": "Mar"
      }
    }
  }
}
```

Specifies the prefix type query

Queries for words that start with "Mar"

This query fetches three movies with actors named Marlon, Mark, and Martin when we search for the prefix "Mar". Note that we are running a `prefix` query on the `actors.original` field, which is the `keyword` data type.

> **NOTE** `Prefix` queries are expensive and can destabilize the cluster. See the "Expensive queries" sidebar in section 9.7 for how to prevent an overloaded cluster and section 9.8.2 to speed up `prefix` queries.

9.8.1 Shortened queries

As we discussed at the beginning of this chapter, we don't need to add an object consisting of values at the field block level. Instead, we can create a shortened version for brevity.

Listing 9.18 Shortening `prefix` query usage

```
GET movies/_search
{
  "query": {
    "prefix": {
      "actors.original":  "Leo"
    }
  }
}
```

As we wish to find the matching fields in the results, we add highlights to the query. Adding a `highlight` block to a `prefix` query accentuates one or more fields that match.

Listing 9.19 A `prefix` search with highlighting

```
GET movies/_search
{
  "_source": false,
  "query": {
    "prefix": {
      "actors.original": {
        "value": "Mar"
```